

Signal failed with “no position opened” — edited message bypassed the AI

Incident report · TScopier Telegram edit/revision path · 2026-09-18

SEVERITY	Medium	STATUS	Fix written — not deployed
DATES	Signal 2026-09-18 16:05 UTC; edit 16:06 UTC; diagnosed 2026-09-19	AFFECTED	1 user — k.eloifabien@gmail.com (ce0fc42d-...bd6be)
COMPONENT	userListener.ts , signalRevision.ts , parseSignal.ts	ROOT CAUSE	Edit path accepted a buy/sell with SL/TP but no entry anchor, so the AI was never consulted

1. Executive summary (plain English)

A signal provider posted a gold buy setup, then **edited** the message a minute later to add the full details — entry zone, take profits, and stop loss. The copier handles an edited message differently from a brand-new one. On an edit, it first tries to understand the message with its built-in rules, and only asks the AI if those rules fail.

The built-in rules accepted the edited message because it had a stop loss and take profits and the same direction as before. Those rules never check whether an entry price is present. The rules also do not recognise the format “ENTRY ZONE: 4358” when only a single price is given — they only understand a range like “4358-4360”.

So the copier accepted the signal without an entry price, never asked the AI for help, and could not open the trade. The user saw “No position opened”. No money was at risk.

2. Issue encountered

- At 2026-09-18 16:05:29 UTC, Telegram message 89381 arrived and signal 4e530999 was created.
- At 2026-09-18 16:06:20 UTC, the provider **edited** the message to the full setup:
 - BUY: XAU/USD ENTRY ZONE: 4358 TP1: 4368 / TP2: 4378 / TP3: 4388 SL: 4348
- The listener logged source=live_edit and dispatched the revision.
- The stored parse had entry_price: null , entry_zone_low: null , entry_zone_high: null , with sl: 4348 and tp: [4368, 4378, 4388] .
- Dispatch failed with entry_not_opened — there was no entry price to send to the broker.
- The admin dashboard showed “OSS context interpretation — Not reached (fast lane / AI disabled)”.

3. Affected user(s)

USER (EMAIL)	SUPABASE ID	CHANNEL	SIGNAL	TRADES
k.eloifabien@gmail.com	ce0fc42d-...bd6be	Lorax Layer VIP	4e530999	0 on this channel; 2 open sells elsewhere

No trades were placed for this signal. No money was at risk.

4. Root cause

- Edits take a different code path than new messages.** tryApplyMessageRevisionInner (userListener.ts:1983) handles Telegram edits. It first calls tryDeterministicRevisionCompletion (userListener.ts:2306) and only calls the AI if that returns null (userListener.ts:2056).
- The revision fast-path does not require an entry anchor.** revisionHasDeterministicActionableParse (signalRevision.ts:238) accepts a revised parse when the action is buy / sell , it carries explicit stops or targets, and the prior action is null or the same direction (signalRevision.ts:258-266). It never checks for entry_price / entry_zone_low / entry_zone_high .
- The parser does not read ENTRY ZONE: <single price> .** extractOptionalEntryAnchor (parseSignal.ts , single-price block at line 1108) understands entry price: , entry: , entry level: , @price , buy at price , and two-price ranges — but not a single price after the words “ENTRY ZONE”.
- Result:** a buy signal with SL/TP but no entry was accepted, the AI was never consulted, and dispatch failed with entry_not_opened .

5. Why this is surprising

The AI normally *would* have caught this. Over the last 7 days, **8,840 of 9,081** signals carried a verification chain:

PATH	COUNT
fast_lane	2,526
stage2_veto	2,600
stage3	2,094
stage2	1,124

With UNIVERSAL_PARSE_MODE=fastpath and UNIVERSAL_PARSE_FASTPATH_CONFIDENCE=0.99 , a 0.93-confidence signal would normally be sent to the AI. The **edit path** is the exception — it does not apply the confidence threshold and decides purely on the parsed shape.

6. The fix (applied)

- A. Parser gap.** parseSignal.ts — added a single-price entry\s*zone\s*[:=]\s*<price> pattern with a negative lookahead so a range (ENTRY ZONE: 4358 / 4360) is still read as a zone. Also added zone|area and / to the entrySlashZone range pattern.
- B. Revision fast-path.** signalRevision.ts — both revision helpers now return false when the message **labels an entry** (helper messageLabelsEntryAnchor) but the parse has no anchor. A genuine market entry (“Gold buy now”, no entry label) is still accepted deterministically.
- C. Fast-lane guard.** universalSignalParser.ts — deterministicQualifiesForFastPath now also returns false for a buy/sell when the message labels an entry the parser missed. The shared helper parsedMissesLabeledEntry backs both B and C.
- D. Phantom entry from numbered TP/SL @ separators.** parseSignal.ts — parseAtPriceExcludingSLTp did not exclude numbered SL/TP labels, so TP1 @ 4256 (and TP 1 @ , TP(1) @ , TP1: @ , Take Profit 1 @) was read as the entry price, which could turn a “SELL NOW” market signal into a limit order at the take-profit price. The exclusion now covers numbered labels with optional separators, mirrored in the guard. The word target is deliberately **not** in the exclusion list, so an entry written as Entry Target @4235 is still read as the entry (a first attempt added target and broke that case).

Rejected approach: the first attempt required an entry anchor on the revised parse. Review found this broke the legitimate market-entry completion (“Gold buy now” edited to add SL/TP has no anchor by design), and evaluateParsedSignalExecutionEligibility would not have caught the incident either (it returns eligible: true for labeled stops with a zero entry price). The label-gap check avoids both.

7. Files changed

- worker/src/parseSignal.ts — Fix A (single-price entry zone with range lookahead) and Fix D (numbered SL/TP @ exclusion).
- worker/src/signalRevision.ts — Fix B: revisedMissesLabeledEntry guard on both revision helpers.
- worker/src/signalEntryNowRequirement.ts — new exported messageLabelsEntryAnchor and parsedMissesLabeledEntry helpers.
- worker/src/signalIntent/universalSignalParser.ts — Fix C: fast-lane guard.
- worker/src/parseSignal.test.ts , signalRevision.test.ts , signalEntryNowRequirement.test.ts , signalIntent/parseRouting.test.ts — regression tests.

8. Verification

- Confirmed against production DB: signal 4e530999 has entry_price / entry_zone_low / entry_zone_high all null , sl: 4348 , tp: [4368,4378,4388] , confidence: 0.93 , skip_reason: entry_not_opened , and no _verification chain.
- Confirmed in Railway listener logs (deployment 59949940 , production): message revision dispatch ... signalId=4e530999 ... source=live_edit .
- Confirmed production runs the AI on most signals: 8,840/9,081 signals in the last 7 days have a verification chain.
- After Fix A: the exact message parses entry_price: 4358 ; ENTRY_ZONE: 4358 / 4360 parses as zone 4358–4360.
- After Fix B/C: a labeled entry the parser missed returns false (AI consulted); market entries and incidental prose remain deterministic/fast-laned.
- After Fix D: TP1 @ , TP 1 @ , TP(1) @ , TP1: @ , TP#1 @ , Take Profit 1 @ no longer set entry_price ; BUY XAUUSD @ 4358 still parses.
- Review regression (signalsProEditFlow.test.ts:42) found on the first attempt was fixed; the test now passes.
- npm --prefix worker run build (ts) passes clean; 260 tests pass across all affected test files, 0 failures.

9. Post-implementation review

Two review subagents were run per project policy.

- **code-tester: PASS.** Typecheck clean; all targeted suites green.
- **code-review: several passes.** Fix B's first attempt (require an entry anchor) was rejected as CRITICAL — it broke the legitimate market-entry completion. The reworked label-gap guard then drew a HIGH false positive (buy|sell at matched “SELL AT MARKET”), then two MEDIUM items (price[:=] matching “TP price:”/“Target price:”, and the modify branch running before the guard). Fix C and the label additions then drew a HIGH (\bfrom\s+\d matching prose) plus MEDIUMs (area , bare entry , the @ SL/TP separator, and numbered TP1 / TP 1 forms). All were fixed and re-verified; the final pass returned PASS_WITH_NOTES with only LOW/INFO items.
- One confirmation pass could not run — the review subagent returned “Insufficient Balance”; that intermediate diff was reviewed manually.

10. Deployment status

Fix written, reviewed, and tested locally. Not committed and not deployed.

11. Follow-ups

- Commit and deploy to staging, then prod.
- Consider whether the revision path should also respect a confidence threshold, or always consult the AI when the revised parse lacks an entry anchor.
- The guard is a regex allow-list; a label neither the parser nor the guard recognises can still skip the AI on an edit. Known residual examples: BUY_ZONE 4358 , buy area 4358 . An inherent limitation to revisit if another such incident appears.
- LOW: parseSLFromText reads the ordinal in SL2 @ 4276 as the stop price (pre-existing, untouched by this fix).
- LOW: prose ending in “entry <n>” (e.g. “wait for a good entry 2 hours ago”) is treated as an entry label; the effect is only an unnecessary AI call (fail-safe), not a wrong trade.